



An Roinn Dlí agus Cirt  
Department of Justice

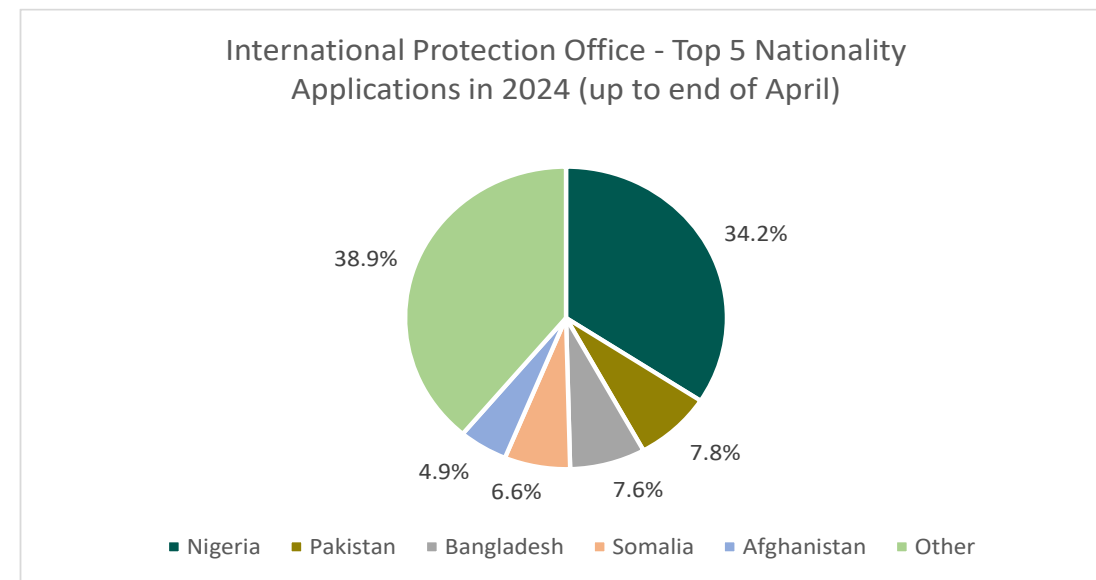
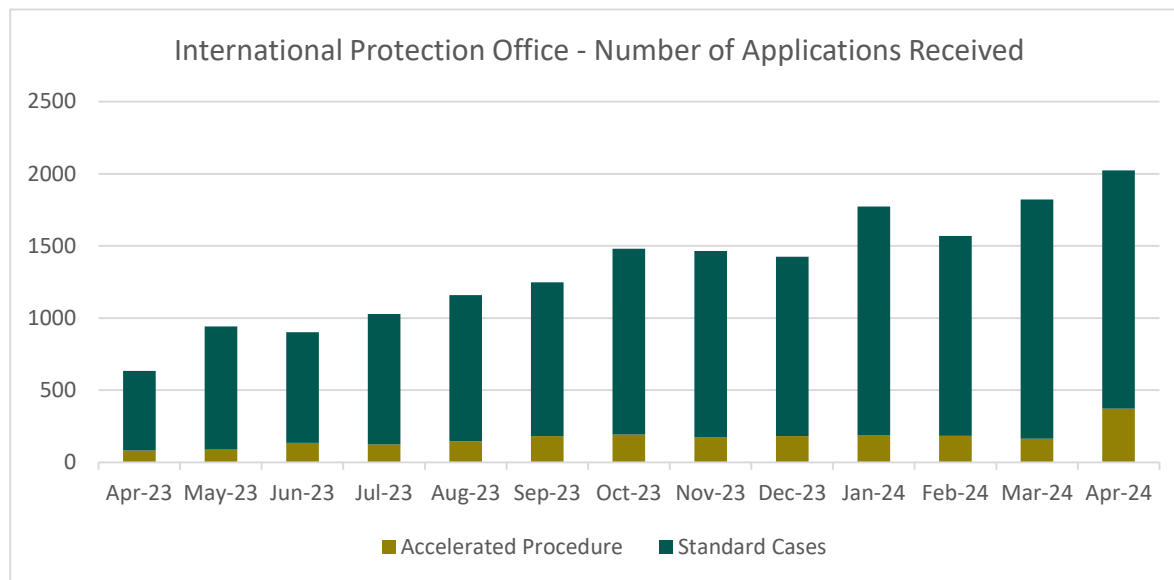
# International Protection: April 2024

# Executive Summary

The figures in this dashboard were extracted on the 6<sup>th</sup> May 2024. These are operational figures and subject to change. The charts below refer to key points in the asylum process. A flow chart is provided at the end of the pack that sets out this process. Overall, for April 2024:

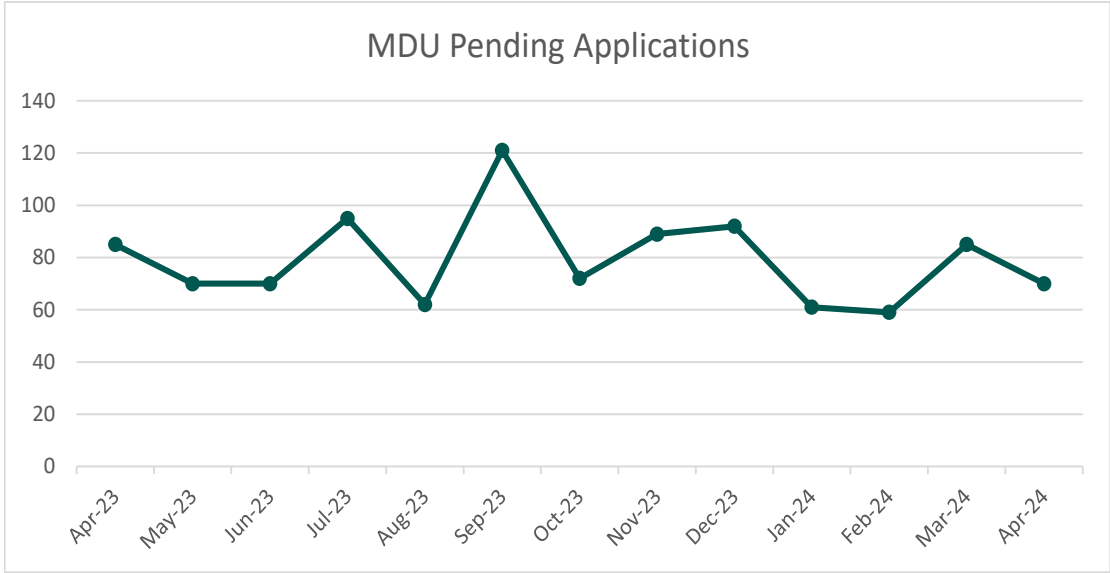
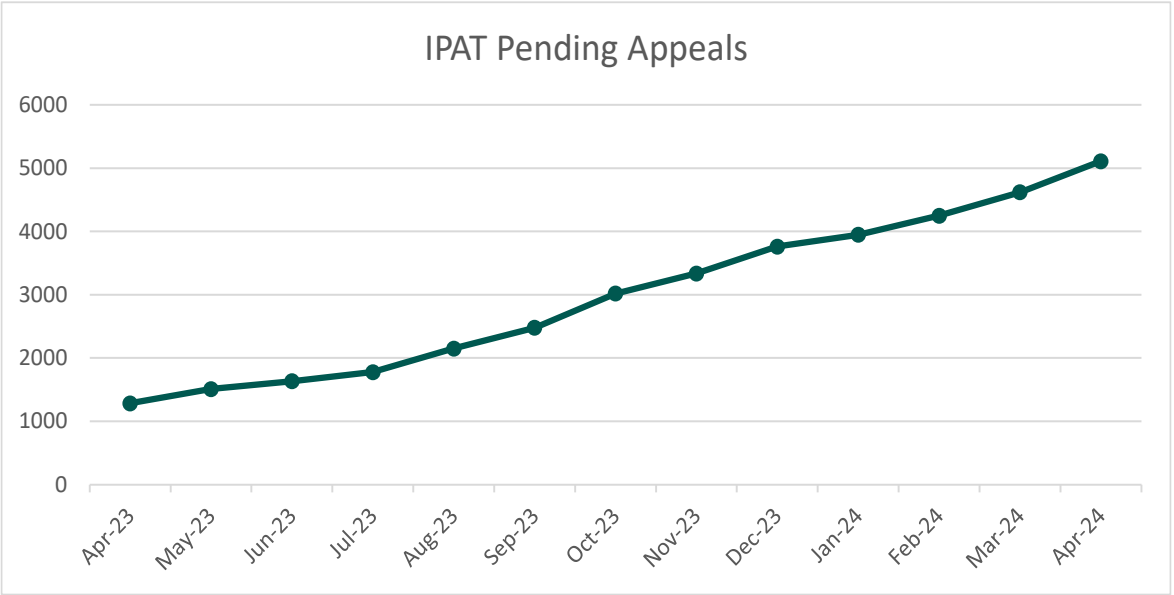
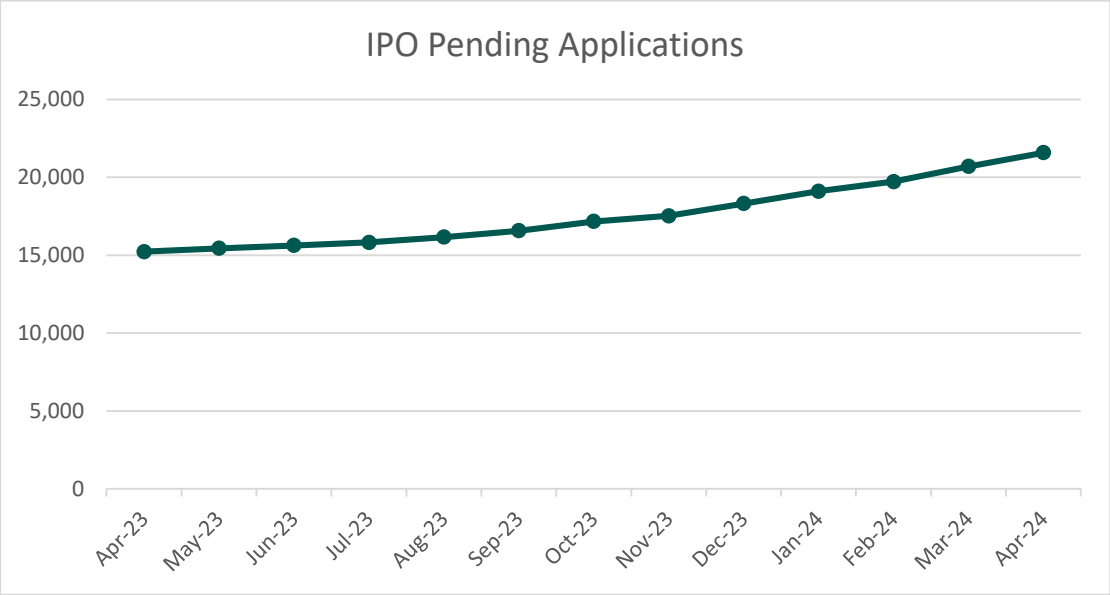
- The number of asylum applications continues to trend upwards. In April there were 2,024 applications received for asylum. This is up from 1,391 last April
- The main countries of origin for 2024 to date are: Nigeria (2,460 applications), Pakistan (559), Bangladesh (545), Somalia (475) and Afghanistan (352)
- The number of applications pending in the IPO is slowly trending upwards. As of April this year there were 21,577 applications pending
- The number of applications in the IPO where a recommendation has been made or otherwise closed off has started to rise in April 2024. In April 2024, 1,135 cases were closed off
- While there has been an increase in the number of cases processed, the median time to make a decision for standard cases has been trending slowly upwards (albeit from significant reductions). In April 2024 the median processing time to determination was 82 weeks (compared to 76 week in January 2024 and 69 in October 2023)
- The number of staff in the IPO has gradually been increasing, up to 405 at the end of April 2024
- Of those applications where a decision was made in April by MDU, 33% of decisions were refusals, 10% permission to remain, and 57% were international protection grants

# Applications and main nationalities



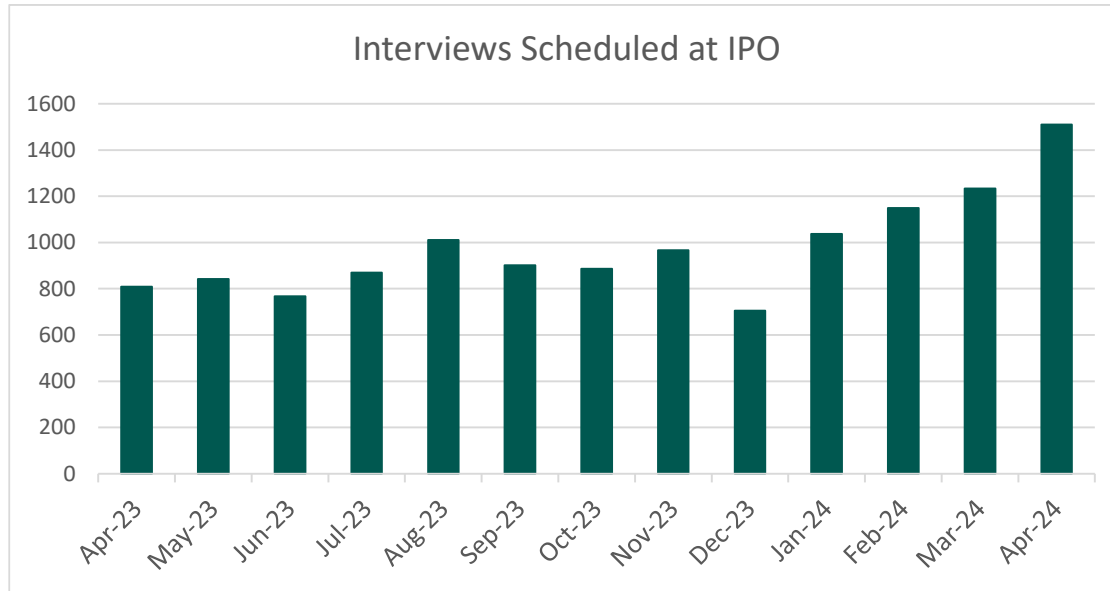
- In April there were 2,024 applications received for asylum. This is up from 1,391 last April. The average number of applications per month between May 2023 and April 2024 was 1,403
- For April 2024, the total number of applications included 372 from accelerated procedure (18% of all applicants)
- The main countries of origin for 2024 to date are: Nigeria (2,460 applications), Pakistan (559), Bangladesh (545), Somalia (475) and Afghanistan (352)

# Pending International Protection Applications

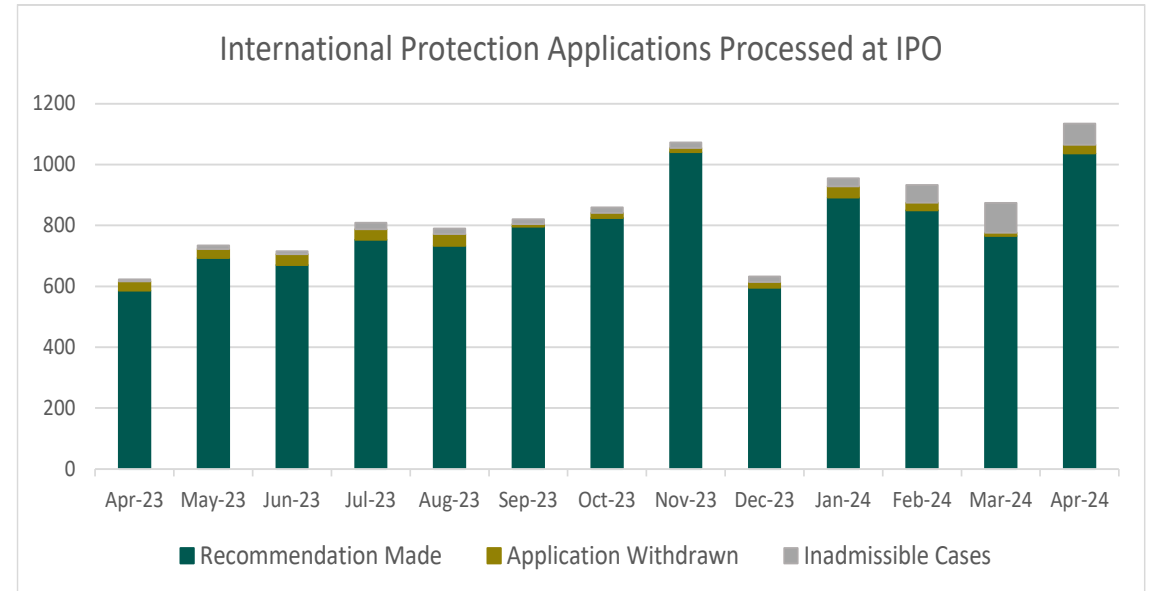


- The number of applications pending in the IPO is 21,577. The numbers have been slightly on the rise from September 2023 (16,566 cases pending)
- The number of pending applications for IPAT has been trending upwards since January 2023. In April 2024, there were 5,110 applications pending
- The pending figure for MDU at the end of April 2024 is 70

# International Protection: Interviews and Applications Processed

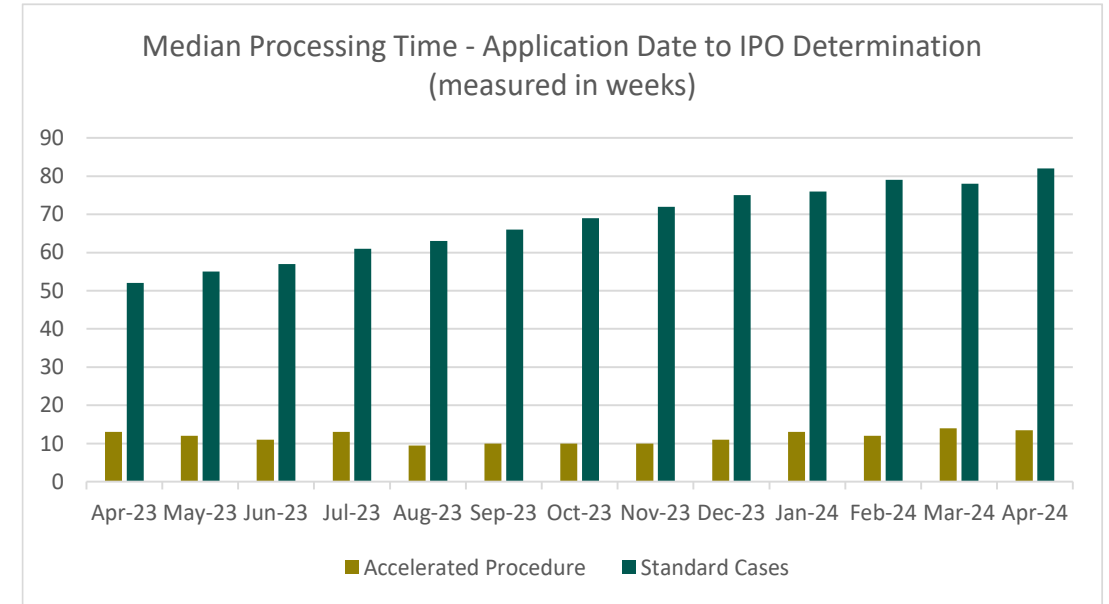
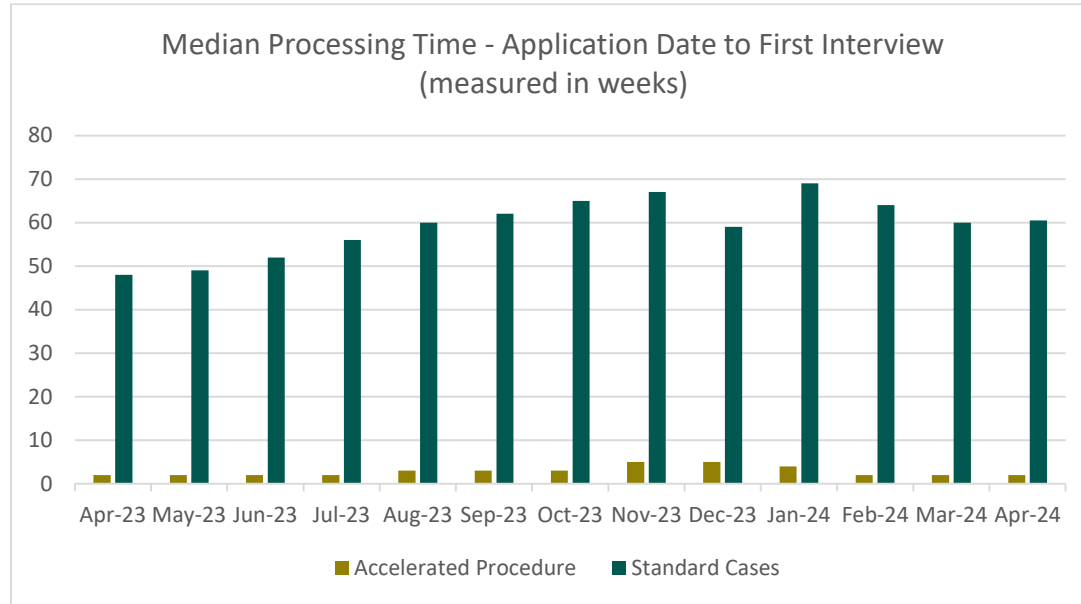


- The number of interviews scheduled at the IPO has been trending up since January 2024
- In April 2024, there were 1,510 interviews scheduled, up from 1,233 in March and 1,149 in February
- 2024 YTD interviews scheduled were 4,929 (a 76.6% increase on 2,791 interviews scheduled for 2023 YTD)



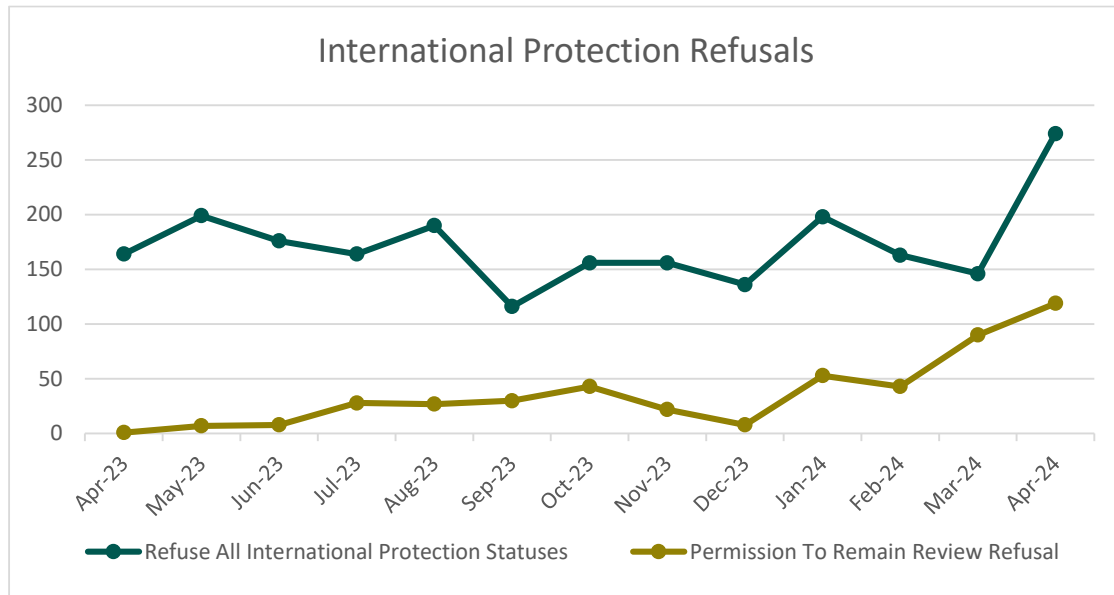
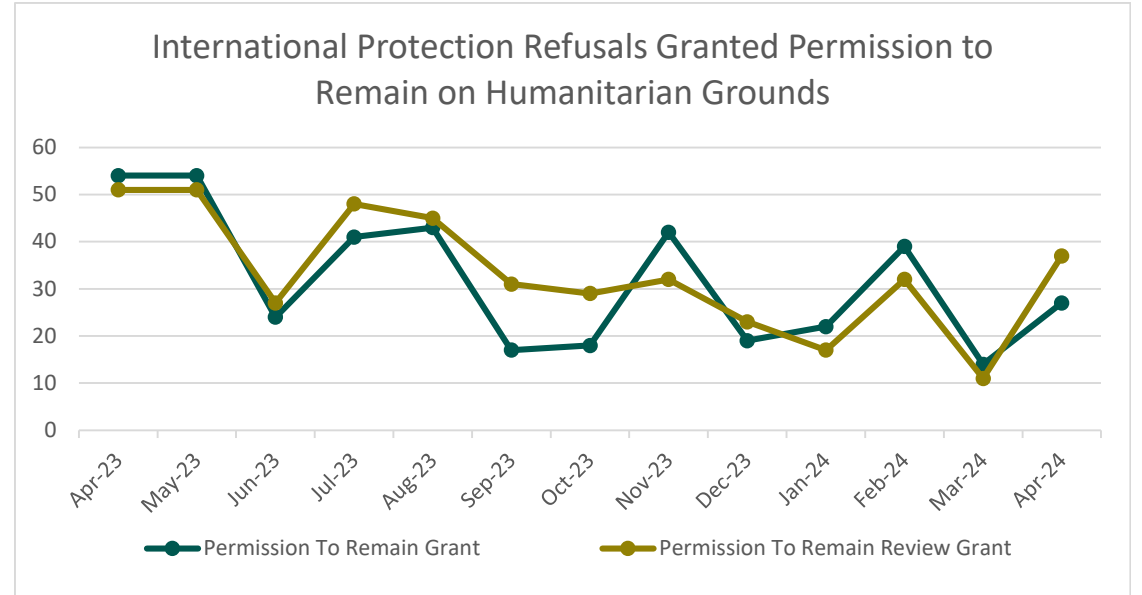
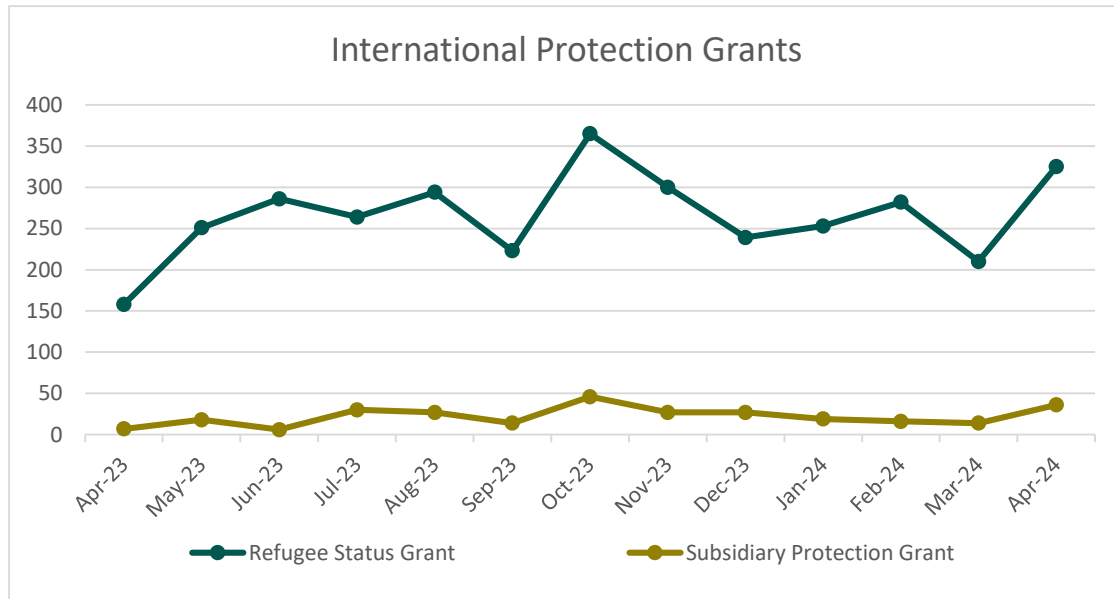
- This table is counting Recommendations Made, Application Deemed Inadmissible and Applications Withdrawn
- In April 2024, 1,135 cases were closed off. This is up from 874 in March and up from 933 in February
- 2024 YTD applications processed were 3,897 (a 54.5% increase on 2,522 applications processed for 2023 YTD)

# International Protection Applications Processing Times



- Processing times are measured as a median. This represents the middle number in the range of times at hand for processing. The reason why the average is not used is that there are a handful of cases where processing times are long – this would disproportionately impact the average figure and not give a proper representation of processing time
- The median time to the first interview for all applications had been slowly decreasing in 2024. In April 2024, it was 60.5 weeks for standard cases, slightly up from 60 weeks in March and down from 64 weeks in February
- For accelerated procedure only cases, the waiting time to the first interview for April was 2 weeks, same time as March and February
- The median processing time to determining an outcome to an asylum application has been slowly increasing
- In April 2024, the median processing time to determination for standard cases was 82 weeks (compared to 78 in March and 79 weeks in February)
- For accelerated procedure only, the median processing time was 13.5 weeks in April, down from 14 in February and up from 12 weeks in February

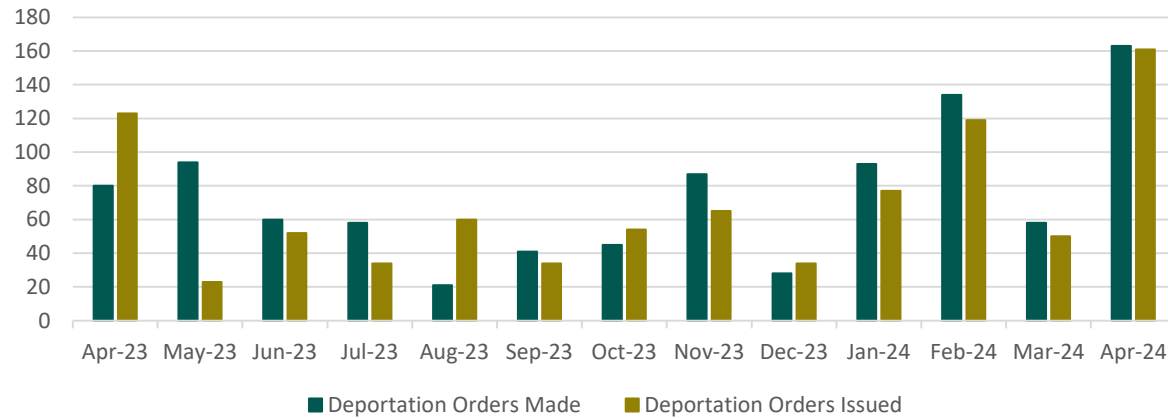
# International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused



- In April, of those applications where a decision was made, 325 were given refugee status grant and 36 subsidiary protection grant (361 in total). There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- Of those who were refused refugee status and subsidiary protection, 27 were given Permission to Remain on humanitarian grounds with 37 on a Permission to Remain Review Grant. The number of Permissions to Remain has been trending downwards since May 2023 (when there were 105 Permissions to Remain)
- There were 209 refusals for International Protection Statuses and 119 for Permission to Remain Review
- Overall for April, 33% of decisions were refusals, 10% permission to remain, and 57% were international protection grants

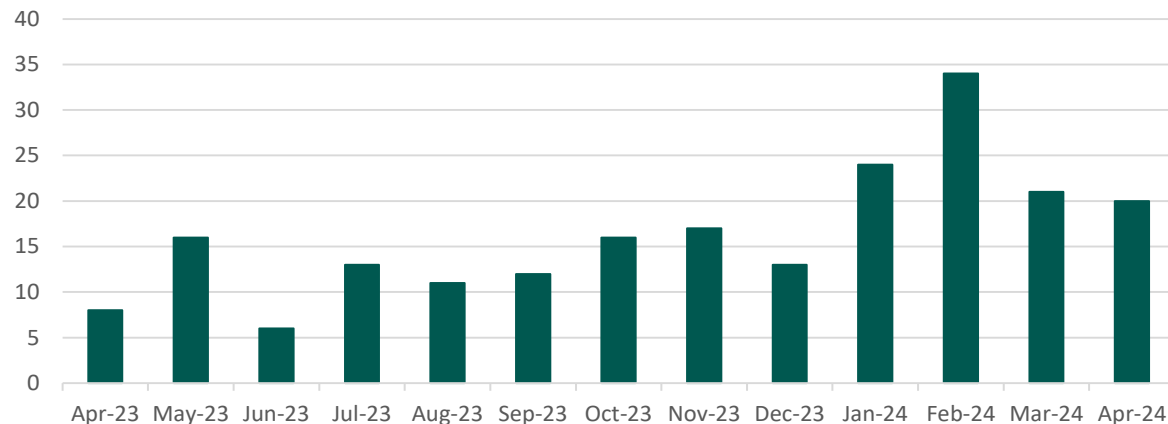
# Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

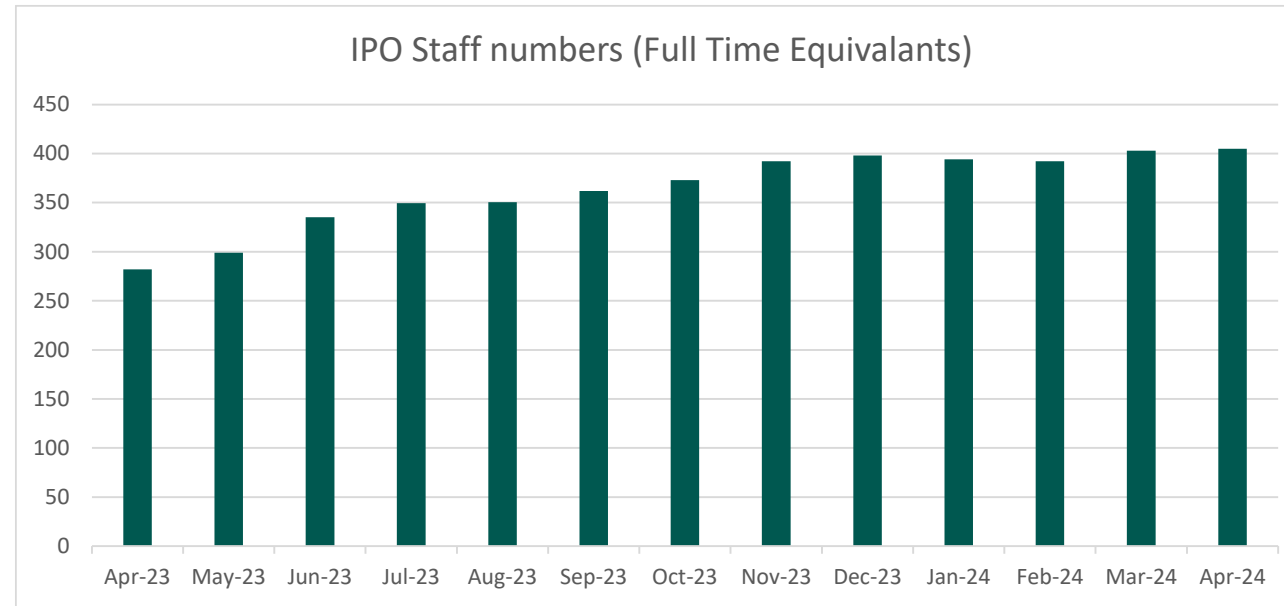


- For April 2024 the number of deportation orders signed (where a person had a previous asylum application) was 163 and the number of deportation orders issued was 161. For March, the figures were 58 and 50 respectively and for February it was 134 and 119 respectively
- For April 2024 the number of removals was 20

Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application



# IPO Staff number (Full-Time Equivalents)



- The number of staff in the IPO has gradually been increasing
- In April 2023 there were 282 FTEs in IPO. This number has been slowly trending upwards. In January 2024 394 and in October 2023 373
- At the end of April 2024, the IPO had 405 FTE staff



# Appendix

# Methodology

## Pending International Protection Applications

- IPO – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- IPAT – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- MDU – Data sourced from AISIP. Pending figure does not include legacy cases – the legacy data has been captured in such a way that it cannot be accurately reported on

## International Protection: Interviews and Applications Processed

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes

## International Protection Applications Processing Times

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- Applicants to whom section 38(5) of the International Protection Act 2015 applies (failure to co-operate) are included in the calculations
- Where an interview took place after a case was reactivated the reactivation date is used as the application date, otherwise the original application date was used for the processing time calculation
- The median calculation is used for processing time at IPO as there are significant outliers in the length of time asylum applications can spend in processing. This is typically due to lengthy procedures such as judicial reviews which are complex and time consuming by their nature, and which are also outside of the remit and control of the IPO during that part of the process. The median is a more accurate measure of the time spent by the IPO in processing applications.

# Methodology

## International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused

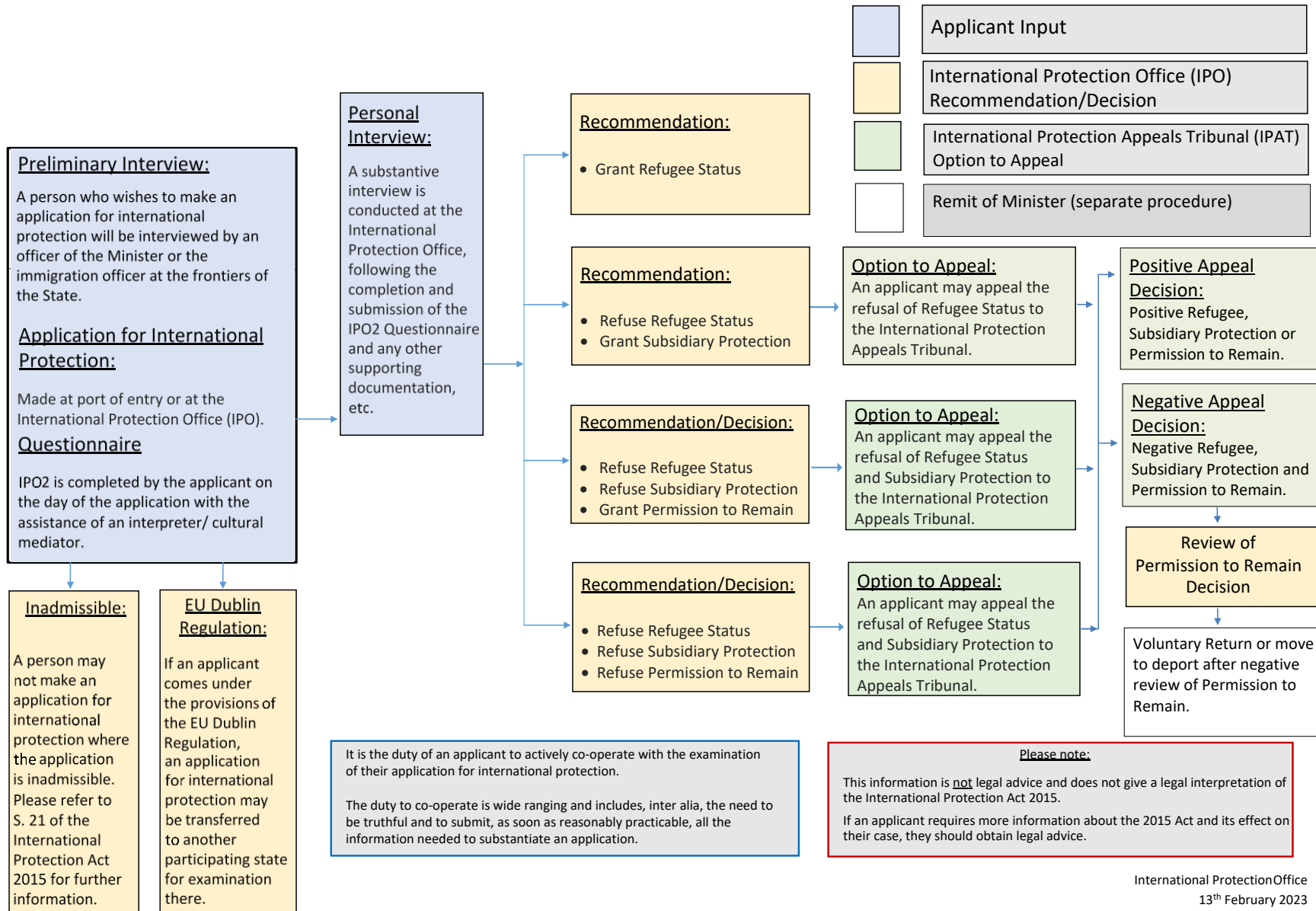
- Quashed decisions and Revocation of Status are not included
- Decision figures include international protection decisions (IPDN) and legacy application types
- Each applicant is represented once in the granted and refused tables
  - For example, if a person is refused refugee status but is granted subsidiary protection they are recorded once in the tables as a subsidiary protection grant. This is to more clearly represent the overall numbers of granted and refused applicants, and to avoid double counting of individuals where they are refused one type of status but are granted another.
- Some of the applicants who have been granted permission to remain are also included in the 'Refuse All International Protection Statuses' category of the refusals table. Permission to remain is a humanitarian permission. In order to be considered for permission to remain you must first have been refused international protection. On slide 7, the 'International Protection Refusals Granted Permission to Remain on Humanitarian Grounds' chart is a combination of applicants still in the asylum process and applicants who have finished the process. The 'International Protection Refusals' chart includes only those applicants who have finished the asylum process.
- Where a revocation occurs the original grant is removed from the figures for the month the permission was originally granted. For example, if an application was granted in January but subsequently revoked later in the year the January figure is updated to remove the grant

## Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

- Data for the International Protection Deportation Order (IPDP) application type is sourced from AISIP. All other data is sourced from Lotus Notes

# General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015

## General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015



# Data Tables (1)

## International Protection Office - Applications Received

|                       | Apr-23 | May-23 | Jun-23 | Jul-23 | Aug-23 | Sep-23 | Oct-23 | Nov-23 | Dec-23 | Jan-24 | Feb-24 | Mar-24 | Apr-24 |
|-----------------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| Accelerated Procedure | 82     | 88     | 135    | 124    | 145    | 182    | 193    | 175    | 182    | 185    | 184    | 163    | 372    |
| Standard Cases        | 551    | 853    | 766    | 904    | 1013   | 1066   | 1288   | 1289   | 1243   | 1588   | 1386   | 1658   | 1652   |

## International Protection Office – Top 5 Nationality Applications

| Top 5 nationalities 2024 to date | Applications | Total |
|----------------------------------|--------------|-------|
| Nigeria                          | 2460         | 34.2% |
| Pakistan                         | 559          | 7.8%  |
| Bangladesh                       | 545          | 7.6%  |
| Somalia                          | 475          | 6.6%  |
| Afghanistan                      | 352          | 4.9%  |
| Other                            | 2796         | 38.9% |
| Total                            | 7187         |       |

## Data Tables (2)

### International Protection Office - Pending Applications

|             | Apr-23 | May-23 | Jun-23 | Jul-23 | Aug-23 | Sep-23 | Oct-23 | Nov-23 | Dec-23 | Jan-24 | Feb-24 | Mar-24 | Apr-24 |
|-------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| IPO Pending | 15,225 | 15,446 | 15,629 | 15,823 | 16,165 | 16,566 | 17,171 | 17,524 | 18,314 | 19,109 | 19,719 | 20,695 | 21,577 |

### International Protection Appeals Tribunal - Pending Applications

|              | Apr-23 | May-23 | Jun-23 | Jul-23 | Aug-23 | Sep-23 | Oct-23 | Nov-23 | Dec-23 | Jan-24 | Feb-24 | Mar-24 | Apr-24 |
|--------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| IPAT Pending | 1284   | 1511   | 1635   | 1777   | 2150   | 2478   | 3020   | 3337   | 3762   | 3949   | 4251   | 4620   | 5110   |

### Ministerial Decisions Unit - Pending Applications

|             | Apr-23 | May-23 | Jun-23 | Jul-23 | Aug-23 | Sep-23 | Oct-23 | Nov-23 | Dec-23 | Jan-24 | Feb-24 | Mar-24 | Apr-24 |
|-------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| MDU Pending | 85     | 70     | 70     | 95     | 62     | 121    | 72     | 89     | 92     | 61     | 59     | 85     | 70     |

# Data Tables (3)

## International Protection Office – Interview Scheduled

|                      | Apr-23 | May-23 | Jun-23 | Jul-23 | Aug-23 | Sep-23 | Oct-23 | Nov-23 | Dec-23 | Jan-24 | Feb-24 | Mar-24 | Apr-24 |
|----------------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| Interviews Scheduled | 809    | 842    | 768    | 870    | 1011   | 902    | 887    | 966    | 705    | 1037   | 1149   | 1233   | 1510   |

## International Protection Office – Processed Cases

|                       | Apr-23 | May-23 | Jun-23 | Jul-23 | Aug-23 | Sep-23 | Oct-23 | Nov-23 | Dec-23 | Jan-24 | Feb-24 | Mar-24 | Apr-24 |
|-----------------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| Recommendation Made   | 586    | 693    | 670    | 753    | 733    | 796    | 825    | 1041   | 595    | 892    | 850    | 766    | 1037   |
| Application Withdrawn | 30     | 30     | 36     | 35     | 39     | 9      | 16     | 14     | 19     | 37     | 25     | 10     | 28     |
| Inadmissible Cases    | 7      | 11     | 9      | 21     | 18     | 15     | 18     | 18     | 18     | 26     | 58     | 98     | 70     |

## Data Tables (4)

### International Protection Office Median Process Time – Application Date to First Interview (measured in weeks)

|                       | Apr-23 | May-23 | Jun-23 | Jul-23 | Aug-23 | Sep-23 | Oct-23 | Nov-23 | Dec-23 | Jan-24 | Feb-24 | Mar-24 | Apr-24 |
|-----------------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| Accelerated Procedure | 2      | 2      | 2      | 2      | 3      | 3      | 3      | 5      | 5      | 4      | 2      | 2      | 2      |
| Standard Cases        | 48     | 49     | 52     | 56     | 60     | 62     | 65     | 67     | 59     | 69     | 64     | 60     | 60.5   |

### International Protection Office Median Process Time – Application Date to IPO Determination (measured in weeks)

|                       | Apr-23 | May-23 | Jun-23 | Jul-23 | Aug-23 | Sep-23 | Oct-23 | Nov-23 | Dec-23 | Jan-24 | Feb-24 | Mar-24 | Apr-24 |
|-----------------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| Accelerated Procedure | 13     | 12     | 11     | 13     | 9.5    | 10     | 10     | 10     | 11     | 13     | 12     | 14     | 13.5   |
| Standard Cases        | 52     | 55     | 57     | 61     | 63     | 66     | 69     | 72     | 75     | 76     | 79     | 78     | 82     |

# Data Tables (5)

## International Protection Decisions – Grants

|                             | Apr-23 | May-23 | Jun-23 | Jul-23 | Aug-23 | Sep-23 | Oct-23 | Nov-23 | Dec-23 | Jan-24 | Feb-24 | Mar-24 | Apr-24 |
|-----------------------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| Refugee Status Grant        | 158    | 251    | 286    | 264    | 294    | 223    | 365    | 300    | 239    | 253    | 282    | 210    | 325    |
| Subsidiary Protection Grant | 7      | 18     | 6      | 30     | 27     | 14     | 46     | 27     | 27     | 19     | 16     | 14     | 36     |
| Permission to Remain Grant  | 54     | 54     | 24     | 41     | 43     | 17     | 18     | 42     | 19     | 22     | 39     | 14     | 27     |
| Permission to Remain Grant  | 51     | 51     | 27     | 48     | 45     | 31     | 29     | 32     | 23     | 17     | 32     | 11     | 37     |

## International Protection Decisions – Refusals

|                                              | Apr-23 | May-23 | Jun-23 | Jul-23 | Aug-23 | Sep-23 | Oct-23 | Nov-23 | Dec-23 | Jan-24 | Feb-24 | Mar-24 | Apr-24 |
|----------------------------------------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| Refuse All International Protection Statuses | 164    | 199    | 176    | 164    | 190    | 116    | 156    | 156    | 136    | 198    | 163    | 146    | 274    |
| Permission to Remain Review Refusal          | 1      | 7      | 8      | 28     | 27     | 30     | 43     | 22     | 8      | 53     | 43     | 90     | 119    |

## Data Tables (6)

### Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

|                           | Apr-23 | May-23 | Jun-23 | Jul-23 | Aug-23 | Sep-23 | Oct-23 | Nov-23 | Dec-23 | Jan-24 | Feb-24 | Mar-24 | Apr-24 |
|---------------------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| Deportation Orders Made   | 80     | 94     | 60     | 58     | 21     | 41     | 45     | 87     | 28     | 93     | 134    | 58     | 163    |
| Deportation Orders Issued | 123    | 23     | 52     | 34     | 60     | 34     | 54     | 65     | 34     | 77     | 119    | 50     | 161    |

### Deportation Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application

| Enforcements and Returns | Apr-23 | May-23 | Jun-23 | Jul-23 | Aug-23 | Sep-23 | Oct-23 | Nov-23 | Dec-23 | Jan-24 | Feb-24 | Mar-24 | Apr-24 |
|--------------------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| Total                    | 8      | 16     | 6      | 13     | 11     | 12     | 16     | 17     | 13     | 24     | 34     | 21     | 20     |

# Data Tables (7)

International Protection Office Staff Numbers (Full-Time Equivalents)

|              | Apr-23 | May-23 | Jun-23 | Jul-23 | Aug-23 | Sep-23 | Oct-23 | Nov-23 | Dec-23 | Jan-24 | Feb-24 | Mar-24 | Apr-24 |
|--------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| IPO Staffing | 282.1  | 299.1  | 335.1  | 349.5  | 350.5  | 361.9  | 373.1  | 392.1  | 398.1  | 394.1  | 392.1  | 402.9  | 404.9  |